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SANZA, a characteristic feature of Zande language and thought

Author(S): Evans-Pritchard, E. E. (Edward Evan)

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(4) *I ni ini bawo rago zo ru* 'they know a male snake at the time of roasting it'. Comment: 'If you have done a man some wrong, such as committing adultery with his wife, he being ignorant of it, other men will tell you that you had better stop acting as you are acting because the husband might get to know about it. It is about that that you speak this *sanza*; however, it is as though one said "you will know it on that day when it comes out, you will then know the truth of it". It is about that that one says they know a male snake at the time of roasting it; because when they begin to roast a python its male member rises to come right out with the heat, so that people see it, whereas before, when it was alive, it was hidden.' (Gore's comment: 'A man's character is known at the time of trial or testing.')

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(5) *Ba gude uwe te* 'a child has not two fathers'. Comment: 'There is a man whose father has died. After his father's death he is truly miserable, for his kinsmen are not agreeable to him, nor also do they marry him a wife. He begins to prosper by his own endeavour and marries several wives and begets children by them. His kinsmen come to his home but they get nothing to eat there and they begin to speak ill of him, saying that he is a mean fellow. He brews beer and invites all his kinsmen to come and drink it. When they are all assembled he rises and speaks to them thus "Why have you spoken ill of me, seeing that I prospered by my own endeavour and no one married me a wife?

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A child has not two fathers; because these many children, I alone am their father. If my father were alive, it is he who would think of me.”

(6) *Sa gara a kati rogo mbaro yo* ‘the lizard’s tail broke off in play’. Comment: ‘This means that there is a man who jokes with you all the time, but his joking is not straight, it has malice in it for you. 📖 207 It is such that should you lose your temper with him he will lose his also and wish to have a quarrel with you. It is about this that people speak this *sanza*, because the man’s joking is not well-intentioned.’ (Gore’s comment: ‘Do not get angry when at play.’ Fr. S. Bervoets gives: *Sa gala nakiti rogo mbaro* ‘de staart van de hagedis breekt af onder ‘t spel’, and some variants.)

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755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

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